

Special Points Decoder

Confluent & Coalescent Points — the Extraordinary Vessels

Standalone reference — pairs with the Week 7 Study Guide

This Decoder Covers:

- Confluent (Opening) Points — the special-point category unique to the 8 vessels; all 4 master-couple pairs drilled in full
- Coalescent Points (Jiao Hui Xue) — how 6 of the 8 vessels borrow points from primary meridians
- Why organ-based special-point categories (Yuan-Source, Luo-Connecting, etc.) do NOT apply this week
- Cumulative one-page recap of every special-point category from Weeks 1-6, for continuity

No new organ-based special points this week -- GV/CV/Chong/Dai/Qiao/Wei pertain to no zang-fu organ. Confluent Points ARE the special-point content for Quiz 5.

Confluent Points (Ba Mai Jiao Hui Xue)

The star category this week

DEFINITION: Confluent points are special acupuncture points -- always located on a primary meridian, one per vessel -- that connect each Extraordinary Vessel to the 12 regular meridians. They are the clinical “opening” points used to access that vessel's function, and they pair up into 4 “master-couple” combinations used together in treatment.

MOA also has a dedicated “Confluent points of the eight extraordinary channels” section at p.45 -- directly on-topic for this week's Decoder but not in the original syllabus range. Not required, but worth asking Dr. Zhang whether it should be.

Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

SP 4 Gongsun × PC 6 Neiguan

Stomach, heart, chest -- Gongsun opens Chong, Neiguan opens Yin Wei; combine to treat chest/epigastric/cardiac patterns.

Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

SI 3 Houxi × BL 62 Shenmai

Inner canthus, neck, ear, shoulder -- spinal stiffness/pain, febrile disease, mental disorders.

Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

LU 7 Lieque × KI 6 Zhaohai

Lung, throat, chest, diaphragm -- cough, sore throat, chest tightness.

Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

GB 41 Zulinqi × SJ 5 Waiguan

Outer canthus, ear, cheek, neck, shoulder -- lateral-body pain, febrile disease, exterior patterns.

MEMORY AID

All 4 pairs put one point on the ARM and one on the LEG. The arm point is always the vessel's confluent point on a Yin (Lung/Pericardium) or Yang (Small Intestine/San Jiao) hand meridian; the leg point mirrors it on the corresponding foot meridian territory (Kidney/Spleen for the yin pairs, Bladder/Gallbladder for the yang pairs).

Coalescent Points (Jiao Hui Xue)

How the vessels without their own points work

DEFINITION: Coalescent points are the meeting points between an Extraordinary Vessel and a primary meridian along the vessel's course. Only GV and CV have their own dedicated points -- the other 6 vessels are described ENTIRELY through the primary-meridian points they cross. Do not confuse a vessel's coalescent points (many, descriptive of its course) with its ONE confluent point (the clinical opening point).

Coalescent Points by Vessel

Governor Vessel (Du Mai) (2 pts)

BL 12 Fengmen · CV 1 Huiyin

Conception Vessel (Ren Mai) (2 pts)

ST 1 Chengqi · GV 28 Yinjiao

Thoroughfare Vessel (Chong Mai) (14 pts)

CV 1 · CV 7 · ST 30 · KI 11 · KI 12 · KI 13 · KI 14 · KI 15 · KI 16 · KI 17 · KI 18 · KI 19 · KI 20 · KI 21

Belt Vessel (Dai Mai) (3 pts)

GB 26 Daimai · GB 27 Wushu · GB 28 Weidao

Yang Heel Vessel (Yang Qiao Mai) (10 pts)

BL 1 · BL 59 · BL 61 · BL 62 · GB 20 · GB 29 · SI 10 · ST 1 · ST 3 · ST 4

• Slide header states "(12)" coalescent points but only 10 are named -- flagged for Dr. Zhang.

Yin Heel Vessel (Yin Qiao Mai) (3 pts)

KI 6 · KI 8 · BL 1

Yang Link Vessel (Yang Wei Mai) (14 pts)

BL 63 · SI 10 · GV 15 · GV 16 · GB 21 · GB 35 · GB 13 · GB 14 · GB 15 · GB 16 · GB 17 · GB 18 · GB 19 · GB 20

• Slide header states "(15)" coalescent points but only 14 are named -- flagged for Dr. Zhang.

Yin Link Vessel (Yin Wei Mai) (7 pts)

KI 9 · SP 13 · SP 15 · SP 16 · LR 14 · CV 22 · CV 23

Cumulative Recap — Categories NOT New This Week

For continuity only

None of the Eight Extraordinary Vessels pertains to a zang or fu organ, and none has an interior-exterior paired relationship the way the 12 primary meridians do. Only Du Mai (GV) and Ren Mai (CV) have their own dedicated acupuncture points -- the other six vessels borrow points from the primary meridians they cross (their “coalescent points,” Jiao Hui Xue).

Because none of the 8 vessels pertains to a zang/fu organ, the organ-based special-point categories drilled in earlier weeks' decoders (Yuan-Source, Luo-Connecting, Xi-Cleft, He-Sea, Lower He-Sea, Front-Mu, Back-Shu, Hui-Meeting, Jing-Well/Ying-Spring/Shu-Stream/Jing-River, Command Points) do not introduce new examples this week. They stay exactly as covered previously -- listed below strictly for cumulative review continuity.

YUAN-SOURCE

Where the Source (Yuan) Qi is accessed.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC7, SJ4, GB40, LR3)

LUO-CONNECTING

Where a Luo-vessel branches to the paired channel.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC6, SJ5, GB37, LR5)

HE-SEA

At elbow/knee; treats counterflow Qi and organ-level disorders.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC3, SJ10, GB34, LR8)

XI-CLEFT

Cleft point for acute conditions/pain.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC4, SJ7, GB36, LR6)

FRONT-MU

Where a zang/fu organ's Qi gathers anteriorly.

Last new examples: Week 6 (CV17, CV5, GB24, LR14)

BACK-SHU

Bladder-channel transport points for each organ.

Last new examples: Week 6 (BL14, BL22, BL19, BL18)

HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL)

8 points, meeting place for a tissue/substance category.

Last new examples: Week 6 (GB34 = Sinews; LR13 = Zang)

JING-WELL / YING-SPRING / SHU-STREAM / JING-RIVER

The Five-Shu points along each channel.

Last new examples: Week 6

LOWER HE-SEA

Special He-Sea points for the 6 Fu organs, on the leg.

Last new examples: Week 6 (SJ's is BL39, off-channel)

CROSSING POINTS

A point crossed by more than one channel's pathway.

GB count still flagged/unresolved (Week 6)